The remaining twenty-six programmes/heads of expenditure were too small to make any significant dent even on any particular aspect of labour welfare.

Contributory Pension Schemes for Unorganized Sector for Workers and Traders Unravelling

In financial year 2019–20, the government introduced two contributory new pension types of schemes for all unorganized sector workers (Pradhan Mantri Shram Yogi Mandhan or PM-SYM) and small traders and farmers (Pradhan Mantri Karma Yogi Mandhan or PM-KYM). The amount spent on these two schemes in 2019–20 was Rs 355.20 crore and Rs 155.87 crore. For financial year 2020–21, revised allocations of Rs 500 crore and Rs 180 crore have been made for these two schemes.

PM-SYM was launched on 5 March 2019, just before the announcement of the general elections for the Lok Sabha, after the provision for the scheme was made in the revised Budget for 2018–19. It provides for a monthly pension of Rs 3000 to unorganized sector workers in the age group of eighteen to forty, on self-declaration basis, provided they make a monthly contribution depending upon the age at which they join. For a worker who is twenty-nine, the monthly contribution is fixed at Rs 100 per month. The monthly contribution for the youngest worker (18 years) is Rs 55; for the oldest (forty years of age), it is Rs 200 per month.

The government has assumed major financial responsibility under the scheme. It is administered by LIC, which makes the investment of the corpus as per the investment pattern approved by the government. The government makes a contribution equal to that of the worker. It has also an underwritten shortfall, if any, in the corpus to discharge its pensionary obligations.

The government had stated that there were about 50 crore workers in the unorganized sector at the time of launching the scheme. By the end of